

Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7) — Paper 4

Chapter 14: India and Her Neighbours

Paper 4 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	14 — India and Her Neighbours
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Classic traps: a neighbour need NOT share a land border (Sri Lanka and the Maldives are maritime neighbours), an 'open border' like India-Nepal still IS a recognised border (only crossing is visa-free), Indian culture reached Thailand, Indonesia and Cambodia PEACEFULLY through trade, travel and religion rather than conquest, landlocked Nepal and Bhutan still depend on the sea via Indian ports, and direction/side mix-ups (Pakistan and Afghanistan lie west/north-west, Bangladesh and Myanmar east, Sri Lanka and the Maldives south). Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. A teacher draws two columns, 'land neighbours' and 'maritime neighbours', and asks the class which single rule decides where each of India's neighbours belongs. The rule that correctly sorts them all is:

- (A) whether the country is larger or smaller than India in area
- (B) whether the country touches India by a land boundary (land neighbour) or is reached across the sea without any shared land border (maritime neighbour)
- (C) whether the country lies to the north or to the south of India
- (D) whether the country uses the same language and currency as India

2. Four countries are listed: Pakistan, Bhutan, Sri Lanka and Bangladesh. Three of them share a LAND border with India and one does not. The odd one out is:

- (A) Pakistan, which is reached only across the sea
- (B) Sri Lanka, which is separated from India by the sea
- (C) Bhutan, which is a maritime island neighbour
- (D) Bangladesh, which has no border with India at all

3. A student says, 'A maritime neighbour is less of a real neighbour than a land one because only land can join two countries.' The best correction is that:

- (A) land neighbours are indeed the only true neighbours and the sea merely separates lands
- (B) maritime neighbours matter only to countries that have no land neighbours at all
- (C) a sea can join countries only if a bridge has first been built across it
- (D) a shared sea has long carried trade, travel and culture between coasts, so a maritime link is just as genuine a neighbourly bond as a land boundary

4. The single best reason India can have maritime neighbours at all is that:

- (A) India is landlocked and ringed entirely by high mountains
- (B) India shares a land border with every island in the region
- (C) the Indian Ocean has no other countries touching its shores
- (D) India has a long coastline and sits centrally in the Indian Ocean, so other coastal lands lie across the water from it

5. Which pairing of a neighbour with the correct TYPE of link is right?

- (A) Nepal — maritime neighbour; Sri Lanka — land neighbour
- (B) China — maritime neighbour; Myanmar — island neighbour
- (C) Bangladesh — land neighbour to the east; the Maldives — maritime neighbour to the south
- (D) Bhutan — coastal neighbour; Pakistan — landlocked neighbour

6. A list claims to give 'only maritime neighbours of India'. Which list is actually correct?

- (A) Nepal and Bhutan
- (B) Pakistan and Afghanistan
- (C) Myanmar and Bangladesh
- (D) Sri Lanka and the Maldives

7. A child argues, 'The Maldives is too small and too far out in the sea to count as India's neighbour.' The strongest reply is that:

- (A) the Maldives must first build a bridge to India before it can count
- (B) only the largest country in a region is ever counted as a neighbour
- (C) distance and size do not decide neighbourliness; the Maldives shares the Indian Ocean with India and is a close maritime neighbour
- (D) the Maldives is in fact one of India's land neighbours to the north

8. Both Sri Lanka and the Maldives are maritime neighbours, yet they differ in form. The most accurate comparison is that:

- (A) Sri Lanka is an archipelago of many islets while the Maldives is one large island
- (B) both are landlocked Himalayan kingdoms with no coastline
- (C) the Maldives is an archipelago of many small islands while Sri Lanka is a single large island
- (D) both share a long land border with India to the south

9. If you sailed in a straight line due SOUTH from India's southern tip, the FIRST neighbouring country you would reach is:

- (A) China, which lies far to the north across the Himalayas
- (B) Sri Lanka, lying just across a narrow strait to the south
- (C) Afghanistan, which lies to the north-west by land
- (D) Bhutan, the landlocked Himalayan kingdom to the north

10. A correct list of India's neighbours that lie to the WEST and NORTH-WEST would be:

- (A) Sri Lanka and the Maldives
- (B) Pakistan and Afghanistan
- (C) Myanmar and Bangladesh
- (D) Bhutan and Nepal

11. Which neighbour lies to India's EAST, sharing a long land border and many transboundary rivers?

- (A) Bangladesh
- (B) Afghanistan, lying to the north-west
- (C) the Maldives, lying to the south-west across the sea
- (D) Pakistan, lying to the west

12. Reading the map in words: China lies to India's _____, while Myanmar lies to India's _____.

- (A) south; west
- (B) west; north-west
- (C) east; south
- (D) north; east

13. A neighbour reached neither by a shared land border nor purely across open sea, but historically by an OVERLAND route through the mountains to the north-west, is:

- (A) the Maldives, reached only across the Indian Ocean
- (B) Sri Lanka, reached only by sailing south
- (C) Indonesia, reached far across the eastern seas
- (D) Afghanistan, linked to India by the ancient northern overland route

14. Going clockwise around India starting from the north-west, the correct order of these neighbours by direction is:

- (A) China (north-west), Afghanistan (north), Sri Lanka (east), Myanmar (south)
- (B) Myanmar (north-west), Sri Lanka (north), China (east), Afghanistan (south)
- (C) Afghanistan (north-west), China (north), Myanmar (east), Sri Lanka (south)
- (D) Sri Lanka (north-west), Myanmar (north), Afghanistan (east), China (south)

15. Two neighbours, Afghanistan and the Maldives, have connected with India in different ways through history. The key difference is that:

- (A) Afghanistan linked to India by overland routes through the north-west, while the Maldives links across the sea to the south
- (B) Afghanistan links across the sea while the Maldives links overland
- (C) both linked only through the northern Himalayas as a pair
- (D) both linked only across the southern Indian Ocean

16. The India-Nepal border is famously an 'open border'. The most accurate meaning is that:

- (A) there is no boundary line between the two countries at all
- (B) Nepal is simply a part of India with no separate government
- (C) the border is sealed with a high wall that cannot be crossed
- (D) the boundary exists and is recognised, but people may cross it freely without a visa or passport

17. Aria says, 'An open border means Nepal and India are really one country.' The best correction is that:

- (A) she is right, because openness legally merges the two states
- (B) she is right, because borders only exist where walls stand
- (C) Nepal and India in fact share a maritime border, not a land one
- (D) an open border still separates two sovereign states; only the crossing rules are relaxed, so the two remain different countries

18. Compared with the open India-Nepal border, the India-China border in the Himalayas is best described as:

- (A) also a land border, but one that is not visa-free and is shaped by high mountains
- (B) an open, visa-free border exactly like the India-Nepal one
- (C) a maritime border running across the Indian Ocean
- (D) not a border at all, since the mountains separate the two countries

19. That the Himalayas form much of the boundary between India and China best illustrates the idea that:

- (A) natural features of the land, like a great mountain range, can mark the border between countries
- (B) every border in the world is drawn along a coastline
- (C) mountains make any contact between neighbours impossible forever
- (D) the position of borders has nothing to do with geography

20. Pakistan and China are compared as India's neighbours. The truth shared by BOTH is that they:

- (A) are maritime neighbours reached only across the sea
- (B) share a land border with India
- (C) are landlocked countries with no coastline of their own
- (D) share an open, visa-free border with India like Nepal's

21. The phrase 'a shared heritage but a divided history', used for India and Pakistan, means the two countries:

- (A) grew from common cultural roots yet were later separated into distinct nations
- (B) have absolutely nothing in common in culture or past

- (C) are today a single country under one government
- (D) were never connected to each other at any point in history

22. A claim says, 'Nepal is landlocked, so it has no use for the sea.' The best refutation is that:

- (A) Nepal has a long ocean coastline of its own to use
- (B) landlocked countries never trade with anyone abroad
- (C) even landlocked Nepal needs the sea for overseas trade, and its goods usually reach the ocean through Indian ports
- (D) Nepal reaches the sea only through Chinese ports across the high Himalayas

23. Nepal and Bhutan share the same key geographic feature shaping their economies. That feature is that they are:

- (A) island nations scattered across the Indian Ocean
- (B) landlocked Himalayan countries with no coastline, depending on India for access to the sea
- (C) long-coastline maritime neighbours of India
- (D) desert countries with no mountains at all

24. The single best reason India's ports matter so much to Nepal and Bhutan is that:

- (A) India's ports give Nepal and Bhutan beaches and coastlines of their own
- (B) a coastline is useless to any country that does not legally own it
- (C) the ports let the two countries turn themselves into island nations
- (D) as landlocked countries they have no coast, so their overseas goods pass through Indian ports, making India their gateway to the sea

25. Bhutan generates much of its electricity from fast-flowing Himalayan rivers chiefly because Bhutan:

- (A) has a flat coastline ideal for tidal power
- (B) imports all of its electricity from distant oceans
- (C) burns sea water to produce its power
- (D) is a mountainous country where water falling from a height can turn turbines (hydroelectricity)

26. Bhutan measures progress through 'Gross National Happiness' rather than money alone. Compared with a country judging success only by wealth, Bhutan's approach gives extra weight to:

- (A) the wellbeing of people, care for the environment, good governance and culture
- (B) the size of its army and its number of weapons
- (C) the total number of islands it controls
- (D) how many tall city skyscrapers it can build

27. A landlocked neighbour and a maritime neighbour differ most clearly in that:

- (A) the landlocked one has the longer coastline of the two
- (B) the maritime one can never trade by sea
- (C) the landlocked one has no coast and must borrow a sea route, while the maritime one is itself reached across the sea
- (D) both have exactly the same access to the ocean

28. Among India's neighbours, the one whose territory lies largely 'in the lap of the Himalayas' and has no coastline is:

- (A) Sri Lanka, a southern island with a long coast
- (B) the Maldives, a chain of low islands in the sea
- (C) Bangladesh, a low-lying delta beside the sea
- (D) Nepal

29. A 'transboundary river' shared by India and Bangladesh creates a need for the two countries to:

- (A) build dams to stop the river crossing the border entirely
- (B) pretend the river does not flow between them at all
- (C) cooperate on how the shared waters are used and managed
- (D) stop speaking to each other about the river forever

30. The Ganga and the Brahmaputra both flow from India into Bangladesh before reaching the sea. The best lesson this teaches about neighbours is that:

- (A) rivers stop flowing the moment they reach a border
- (B) each country can use a shared river without affecting the other
- (C) rivers ignore political borders, so upstream and downstream neighbours are tied together and must manage water jointly
- (D) borders completely separate the two countries' water supplies

31. Which statement about the Himalayas as a shared geographic feature is most accurate?

- (A) the Himalayas are shared by several neighbours and feed great rivers that flow into India and beyond
- (B) the Himalayas lie wholly within India and touch no neighbour
- (C) the Himalayas are a desert range that blocks all rivers
- (D) the Himalayas are a maritime feature out in the Indian Ocean

32. That India shares both the Himalayas and major rivers with several neighbours best shows that the neighbourhood is bound together by:

- (A) a single shared government ruling over all the countries
- (B) a common physical geography that crosses political borders
- (C) one common currency used by every neighbour
- (D) borders that keep each country's geography fully separate

33. Why does shared geography often push neighbours toward cooperation rather than conflict?

- (A) shared geography lets one country fully control everyone's resources
- (B) features like rivers and mountains span borders, so managing them well requires neighbours to work together
- (C) shared rivers and ranges belong to no one, so no one need discuss them
- (D) geography is purely decorative and has no practical effect on neighbours

34. A river beginning in the Himalayas, flowing through India, and emptying into the sea only after passing into Bangladesh best illustrates the concept of a:

- (A) transboundary river crossing the borders of more than one country
- (B) landlocked lake with no outlet to the sea
- (C) strait separating two large landmasses
- (D) river that flows entirely within one country

35. The shared use of Himalayan-fed rivers by India and its northern and eastern neighbours best supports the conclusion that:

- (A) each country's rivers are entirely its own and affect no one else
- (B) neighbours' fortunes are linked by the same waters, making cooperation over rivers a regional necessity
- (C) the rivers vanish at every international border
- (D) water is too unimportant for neighbours to ever discuss

36. Thai kings have taken the name 'Rama' and an old Thai capital was called 'Ayutthaya', echoing Ayodhya. The best explanation is that:

- (A) Indian culture and stories like the Ramayana spread peacefully to Thailand through trade, travel and religion
- (B) India conquered Thailand and forced these names upon it
- (C) Thailand once ruled over India and copied the names back
- (D) the resemblance is pure coincidence with no real connection

37. A claim states, 'India became influential in Indonesia and Cambodia because it conquered them with armies.' The best correction is that:

- (A) yes, large Indian armies marched in and ruled these lands
- (B) the influence appeared only in the last few decades
- (C) those lands show no traces of Indian culture at all
- (D) Indian culture spread there mainly through trade, travel and religion, not by military conquest

38. The great temple complex of Angkor Wat in Cambodia, with its Hindu themes, is best understood as evidence that:

- (A) India physically built the temple as a colony it ruled
- (B) Cambodia had no contact with India at any time

- (C) the temple was carried piece by piece from India by ship
- (D) Indian religion and art spread across the seas to South-East Asia and were adapted there

39. Thailand's 'Ramakien' is best described as:

- (A) an exact, unchanged copy of the Indian Ramayana
- (B) a Thai overland trade route to India
- (C) Thailand's own retelling of the Ramayana, shaped by Thai culture
- (D) one of the three great schools of Buddhism

40. The Borobudur monument, often cited as evidence of Indian cultural influence abroad, is located in:

- (A) Bhutan
- (B) Afghanistan
- (C) the Maldives
- (D) Indonesia

41. The single most important difference between how Indian culture reached Afghanistan and how it reached Indonesia is that:

- (A) it reached both only by conquest and warfare
- (B) it reached Afghanistan by sea and Indonesia by land
- (C) it reached Afghanistan largely by overland routes and Indonesia largely across the seas
- (D) it reached neither, and both developed in total isolation

42. The ancient Indian name 'Suvarnabhumi' (Golden Land) for parts of South-East Asia, together with Indian-style temples there, best supports the conclusion that:

- (A) Indians knew of and exchanged culture with South-East Asia long ago through sea trade
- (B) South-East Asia was completely unknown to ancient Indians
- (C) the temples were built by Indian colonial armies
- (D) the name proves India physically owned the region

43. Buddhism spread from India to its neighbours in three great schools. This outward spread of a faith born in India shows that India was:

- (A) a country that imported Buddhism from a distant continent
- (B) a land completely sealed off from all its neighbours
- (C) unwilling to share any culture beyond its own borders
- (D) a place where ideas originated and then travelled outward to other lands

44. The three great schools of Buddhism named in the chapter are:

- (A) Uttarapatha, Dakshinapatha and the Silk Route
- (B) Theravada, Mahayana and Vajrayana
- (C) Kharif, Rabi and Zaid
- (D) Sovereign, Secular and Socialist

45. The 'Uttarapatha' is best described as:

- (A) the ancient northern overland trade route linking the Ganga plains toward Central Asia through the north-west
- (B) a southern sea route running to Sri Lanka
- (C) one of the three great schools of Buddhism
- (D) a single high Himalayan mountain peak

46. The Uttarapatha and the Dakshinapatha were respectively the ancient:

- (A) two great schools of Buddhism
- (B) northern and southern overland trade routes of India
- (C) two seasonal cropping cycles
- (D) two maritime island neighbours

47. The Silk Route and the old spice routes mattered for India's neighbourhood because they:

- (A) carried goods, ideas and culture back and forth between regions
- (B) sealed India off completely from every other land
- (C) moved only soldiers and never any goods
- (D) came into being only in modern times

48. That India was linked to its neighbours by routes like the Uttarapatha and the spice routes long ago best shows that India's regional ties are:

- (A) brand-new, formed only in the twenty-first century
- (B) very old, built up over many centuries of trade and exchange
- (C) purely military, based only on armies
- (D) based entirely on conquest and never on trade

49. A 'diaspora' connecting India with other countries refers to:

- (A) a narrow channel of sea between two coasts
- (B) communities of people who have spread out and settled far from their original homeland
- (C) a chain of small islands in the ocean
- (D) one of the great schools of Buddhism

50. Iran and Oman are best described in this chapter as India's:

- (A) eastern island neighbours across the Pacific
- (B) landlocked Himalayan neighbours to the north
- (C) ancient western neighbours, linked to India by sea and old trade
- (D) Arctic neighbours far to the north

51. SAARC, the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, was created mainly to:

- (A) help one country conquer the others in the region
- (B) end all trade between the South Asian countries
- (C) replace each member country's own government
- (D) promote cooperation and shared progress among the countries of South Asia

52. SAARC bringing several South Asian countries together is best understood as an example of:

- (A) the merging of all members into one single nation
- (B) regionalism — neighbours working together for peace, stability and shared progress
- (C) each country cutting all ties with its neighbours
- (D) one nation ruling all the others by force

53. Why might a small neighbour like the Maldives still matter greatly to India within a body like SAARC?

- (A) regional security and friendship depend on every member, so even small island neighbours count
- (B) only the largest member's views matter, so small ones can be ignored
- (C) small countries have nothing at all to offer the region
- (D) small island countries cannot really be members at all

54. A 'bilateral' agreement between India and a neighbour is one made:

- (A) among all the countries of the world at once
- (B) between the two countries — the two sides involved
- (C) within a single country only, with no neighbour
- (D) between a country and the open sea

55. Cooperation among neighbours over a shared transboundary river is best handled by:

- (A) one country deciding alone and ignoring the others
- (B) leaving the river entirely unmanaged by anyone
- (C) agreements between the countries that share the river, so each side's needs are considered
- (D) letting a distant continent decide for the region

56. A student writes: 'Sri Lanka shares a long land border with India in the north, and Nepal is a maritime neighbour reached by sea.' How many of these two claims are correct?

- (A) Neither claim is correct
- (B) Only the claim about Sri Lanka is correct
- (C) Only the claim about Nepal is correct
- (D) Both claims are correct

57. Assertion (A): Sri Lanka is one of India's neighbours. Reason (R): A country must share a land border to be a neighbour. Choose the best evaluation.

- (A) Both A and R are true, and R correctly explains A
- (B) A is false and R is true
- (C) A is true but R is false; Sri Lanka is a neighbour through the sea, and a land border is not required
- (D) Both A and R are false

58. Assertion (A): Landlocked Nepal still depends on the sea. Reason (R): Nepal's overseas goods usually travel through Indian ports to reach the ocean. Choose the best evaluation.

- (A) Both A and R are true, but R does not explain A
- (B) A is true but R is false

(C) Both A and R are true, and R correctly explains A

(D) A is false but R is true

59. Assertion (A): Indian culture is found in Thailand and Cambodia. Reason (R): India conquered these lands and forced its culture on them. Choose the best evaluation.

(A) Both A and R are true, and R correctly explains A

(B) A is false but R is true

(C) A is true but R is false; the culture spread peacefully through trade, travel and religion, not conquest

(D) Both A and R are false

60. A student writes: 'The Maldives is too small to be a neighbour, Nepal's open border means it is part of India, and Indians learned Buddhism from Indonesia.' How many of these three statements are correct?

(A) None of the three is correct

(B) Exactly one is correct

(C) Exactly two are correct

(D) All three are correct

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 14: India and Her Neighbours — Paper 4

Paper 4 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	B	11	A	21	A	31	A	41	C	51	D
2	B	12	D	22	C	32	B	42	A	52	B
3	D	13	D	23	B	33	B	43	D	53	A
4	D	14	C	24	D	34	A	44	B	54	B
5	C	15	A	25	D	35	B	45	A	55	C
6	D	16	D	26	A	36	A	46	B	56	A
7	C	17	D	27	C	37	D	47	A	57	C
8	C	18	A	28	D	38	D	48	B	58	C
9	B	19	A	29	C	39	C	49	B	59	C
10	B	20	B	30	C	40	D	50	C	60	A

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (B) The chapter sorts neighbours by the kind of physical link: a land boundary makes a land neighbour, while a country reached only across the sea is a maritime neighbour. Size does not decide this, since both large and small countries appear in each group. North-versus-south is a direction, not the land-or-sea test. Shared language or currency is never the basis for neighbourliness in the chapter.

2. (B) Pakistan, Bhutan and Bangladesh all share land boundaries with India, while Sri Lanka lies across the sea and is a maritime neighbour, making it the odd one out. Pakistan has a land border, not a sea-only link. Bhutan is a landlocked Himalayan land neighbour, not a maritime island. Bangladesh shares a long land border, so the claim it has no border is false.

3. (D) The chapter treats maritime neighbours as fully genuine because the sea has carried trade, travel and culture between coasts for centuries. Saying only land joins

countries ignores this sea-borne exchange. A sea link counts regardless of whether a country also has land neighbours. No bridge is needed for a maritime link to be real.

4. (D) Maritime neighbours exist because India's long coast faces the Indian Ocean, with lands like Sri Lanka and the Maldives across the water. India is not landlocked; it has an extensive coastline. It does not share land borders with islands. Many countries rim the Indian Ocean, which is exactly why India has maritime neighbours.

5. (C) Bangladesh shares a long land border to the east while the Maldives is reached across the sea to the south, so this pairing is correct. Nepal is landlocked and Sri Lanka is across the sea, so that pairing is reversed. China is a land neighbour across the Himalayas and Myanmar is a land neighbour, not an island. Bhutan is landlocked, not coastal, and Pakistan has a coastline, so it is not landlocked.

6. (D) Sri Lanka and the Maldives are both reached across the sea, so they are India's maritime neighbours. Nepal and Bhutan are landlocked Himalayan land neighbours. Pakistan and Afghanistan are western land-linked neighbours. Myanmar and Bangladesh are eastern land neighbours.

7. (C) Neighbourliness rests on a shared sea or border, not on size or exact distance, so the small Maldives is still a maritime neighbour. No bridge is needed for a maritime link. There is no rule that only large countries qualify. The Maldives has no land border and lies to the south, not the north, so it is maritime, not a northern land neighbour.

8. (C) Both are reached across the sea, but the Maldives is a chain of many small islands (a 'nation of islets') and Sri Lanka is one big island. The description that reverses these is wrong. Neither is landlocked or Himalayan. Neither shares any land border with India.

9. (B) Sri Lanka sits just off India's southern tip across a narrow strait, so it is the nearest land reached by sailing south. China lies to the north beyond the Himalayas, the opposite direction. Afghanistan is to the north-west by land. Bhutan is landlocked in the northern Himalayas, unreachable by sailing south.

10. (B) Pakistan lies to India's west and Afghanistan to the north-west, both historically land-linked. Sri Lanka and the Maldives are maritime neighbours to the south. Myanmar and Bangladesh lie to the east. Bhutan and Nepal lie along the northern Himalayas, not the west.

11. (A) Bangladesh lies to India's east, sharing a long land border and rivers that flow across the boundary. Afghanistan is to the north-west. The Maldives is a maritime neighbour to the south-west. Pakistan lies to the west. Only Bangladesh fits the eastern, river-sharing description.

12. (D) China is India's great northern neighbour across the Himalayas, and Myanmar lies on India's eastern land border as the gateway to South-East Asia. China is not to the south,

nor Myanmar to the west. China is not to the west, nor Myanmar to the north-west. China is not to the east, nor Myanmar to the south.

13. (D) Afghanistan was tied to India by the old northern overland route through the north-west. The Maldives and Sri Lanka are reached across the sea. Indonesia lies far across the eastern seas, a maritime link, not an overland one.

14. (C) Moving clockwise from the north-west, Afghanistan sits north-west, China to the north, Myanmar to the east and Sri Lanka to the south. The other sequences swap these directions: China is not north-west, Myanmar is not north-west, and Sri Lanka is not north-west. Only the first ordering matches each country's real position.

15. (A) Afghanistan's ties ran along old overland routes to the north-west, whereas the sea-girt Maldives links by sea to the south. The reversed statement is wrong. Neither pair connects only through the northern Himalayas. They do not both connect by the southern ocean; only the Maldives does.

16. (D) An open border is a real, agreed boundary that people may cross without visas — open in access, not absent. Saying there is no boundary confuses 'open' with 'non-existent'. Nepal is a separate sovereign country, not part of India. An open border is the opposite of a sealed wall.

17. (D) An open border keeps the legal line between two nations while easing crossing, so the two stay separate sovereign states. Openness does not merge them. Borders exist by agreement, not only where walls stand. India and Nepal share a land border, not a maritime one.

18. (A) Both are land borders, but the India-China boundary is not the open, visa-free kind that India-Nepal is, and it runs through the high Himalayas. It is not visa-free like Nepal's. It is on land, not across the ocean. A mountain range marks a border rather than removing it.

19. (A) A boundary following a mountain range shows geography shaping borders. Not every border is coastal; many follow rivers or mountains. Mountains hinder but never wholly prevent contact, as old passes show. The example directly contradicts the idea that geography is irrelevant to borders.

20. (B) Both Pakistan and China have land boundaries with India. Neither is a sea-only neighbour. Pakistan in fact has a coastline, so 'both landlocked' is false. Neither shares the visa-free open arrangement that marks the India-Nepal border.

21. (A) The phrase points to deep common roots alongside a later political separation into distinct nations. It is not a claim of having nothing in common. They are not one country today. And they were closely connected historically, not unconnected.

- 22. (C)** A landlocked country still depends on the sea for overseas trade and routes its goods through a neighbour's ports — for Nepal, mainly India's. Nepal has no coast of its own. Landlocked countries do trade abroad; they simply borrow a route to the sea. The far easier main gateway is Indian ports, not crossing the high Himalayas.
- 23. (B)** Nepal and Bhutan are both landlocked Himalayan states without coastlines, relying on India to reach the sea. Neither is an island nation. Neither has a coastline, so they are not maritime neighbours. They are mountainous, not desert, lands.
- 24. (D)** India's ports act as transit points so landlocked neighbours can ship goods overseas — India is their sea gateway. The coast does not give them beaches of their own. A neighbour's coast is far from useless; it provides the sea access landlocked states lack. A coastline cannot turn an inland country into islands.
- 25. (D)** Steep mountain rivers give the falling water needed for hydroelectricity, which suits Bhutan's terrain. Being landlocked, it has no coastline for tidal power. It produces, not merely imports, power. Burning sea water is not a real source of electricity.
- 26. (A)** Gross National Happiness counts wellbeing, environment, governance and culture beyond pure income. It is not a measure of military strength. Bhutan, being landlocked, has no islands to count. It is not a measure of skyscrapers either.
- 27. (C)** A landlocked country has no coastline and depends on a neighbour for sea access, whereas a maritime neighbour is a coastal land reached over the sea. A landlocked country has no coastline at all, let alone a longer one. A maritime neighbour trades by sea by definition. Their sea access is plainly different, not identical.
- 28. (D)** Nepal nestles in the Himalayas and is landlocked, with no coastline. Sri Lanka is a southern island with a coast. The Maldives is a low island chain in the sea. Bangladesh is a delta country with a coastline. Only Nepal fits the Himalayan, coastless description.
- 29. (C)** Because a transboundary river serves both countries, sharing it sensibly calls for cooperation over its waters. Stopping the flow with dams would harm the downstream country and breed conflict. Ignoring the river does not make the shared dependence vanish. Refusing to talk worsens, rather than manages, the shared resource.
- 30. (C)** A river crossing a border binds upstream and downstream neighbours, so joint management makes sense. Rivers do not halt at borders; that is why they are called transboundary. What one country does upstream affects the other downstream, so use is not independent. Shared rivers connect, rather than separate, water supplies.
- 31. (A)** The Himalayan range stretches across several countries and is the source of major rivers feeding the region. It is not wholly within India; Nepal, Bhutan and others share it. It is a snow-fed mountain system, not a desert, and it gives birth to rivers rather than blocking them. It is a land feature, not a maritime one.

32. (B) Shared mountains and rivers mean the region's physical geography spills across borders, linking the countries. There is no single government over them; each is sovereign. They do not share one currency. The very fact that geography is shared shows borders do not fully separate it.

33. (B) Because rivers and ranges straddle borders, sensible management needs joint effort, encouraging cooperation. No single country can fully control a feature shared with others. Shared resources demand more discussion, not less. Geography has very practical effects, such as on water and trade.

34. (A) A river that flows across one or more borders on its way to the sea is transboundary. It is not a closed landlocked lake. A strait is a narrow sea channel, not a river. By definition it does not stay within one country.

35. (B) Common rivers tie neighbours' water security together, so cooperation is a practical necessity. The rivers are shared, not entirely each country's own. They cross borders rather than vanishing at them. Water is among the most important shared concerns, not unimportant.

36. (A) The echoes of Indian names reflect cultural influence carried peacefully by traders, travellers and teachers. There was no Indian conquest of Thailand. Thailand did not rule India. The pattern of names and epics is too consistent to be mere coincidence.

37. (D) Indian ideas, religion and art travelled to South-East Asia by peaceful exchange, not conquest. There were no large conquering Indian armies in these lands. The influence is ancient, not recent. Monuments and stories show clear traces, so denying any influence is false.

38. (D) Angkor Wat shows Indian religious and artistic ideas taking root and being adapted in South-East Asia. India did not rule Cambodia as a colony to build it. Far from having no contact, Cambodia absorbed strong Indian influence. The temple was built locally, not shipped from India.

39. (C) The Ramakien is a distinctly Thai version of the Ramayana, adapted to local culture. It is not an unchanged copy. It is an epic, not a trade route. It is a story, not a Buddhist school.

40. (D) Borobudur, a vast Buddhist monument reflecting Indian influence, stands in Indonesia. It is not in Bhutan, Afghanistan or the Maldives. Its location across the eastern seas shows Indian culture spreading by maritime contact.

41. (C) Overland routes carried Indian influence north-west to Afghanistan, while sea routes carried it to island Indonesia. Neither spread by conquest. The directions are not reversed — Afghanistan is overland, Indonesia maritime. Both clearly received Indian influence, so neither was isolated.

42. (A) An Indian name for the region plus shared temple styles shows long-standing maritime exchange and knowledge of South-East Asia. Far from unknown, the area had an Indian name. The temples reflect influence, not colonial conquest. A place-name does not amount to ownership.

43. (D) Buddhism arose in India and then spread outward, so India was a source of ideas for others. It did not import Buddhism from afar; the faith began there. Such spread shows openness, not sealing-off. Sharing culture so widely contradicts any unwillingness to share.

44. (B) Theravada, Mahayana and Vajrayana are the three great schools of Buddhism. Uttarapatha, Dakshinapatha and the Silk Route are trade routes, not schools. Kharif, Rabi and Zaid are cropping seasons. 'Sovereign, Secular and Socialist' are words from the Preamble, not Buddhist schools.

45. (A) The Uttarapatha was the great northern overland trade route running toward Central Asia via the north-west. It was overland in the north, not a southern sea route. It was a trade route, not a Buddhist school. It was a route, not a single peak.

46. (B) Uttarapatha was the northern route and Dakshinapatha the southern, both overland trade routes. They were routes, not Buddhist schools. They were not cropping seasons. They were land routes, not island neighbours.

47. (A) These routes were channels for goods, ideas and culture flowing between regions, knitting neighbours together. They opened India to exchange rather than sealing it off. They carried trade goods, not only soldiers. They are ancient, not modern, networks.

48. (B) Ancient trade routes prove India's neighbourly ties are centuries old. They are not a recent twenty-first-century creation. The routes carried trade and culture, not just armies. The links grew through trade and exchange, not conquest.

49. (B) A diaspora is people who have moved and settled away from their homeland, forming links between countries. A narrow sea channel is a strait, not a diaspora. A chain of islands is an archipelago. A school of Buddhism is a religious tradition, not a community abroad.

50. (C) Iran and Oman lie to India's west and have long been linked by sea trade. They are not eastern Pacific islands. They are not landlocked Himalayan states. They are nowhere near the Arctic. They belong to India's wider western, sea-linked neighbourhood.

51. (D) SAARC exists to foster cooperation and joint progress among South Asian nations. It is not a tool of conquest. It aims to encourage, not end, regional trade and contact. It does not replace member governments; each stays sovereign.

52. (B) SAARC embodies regionalism, the idea of neighbours cooperating for common good. The members do not merge into one nation; they remain separate. The aim is more

ties, not cutting them. It is cooperation among equals, not rule by force.

53. (A) Regional peace and security rest on cooperation with every neighbour, so even a small island state matters. Size does not erase a member's importance. Small countries contribute to trade, security and friendship. Small island states are full neighbours and can take part.

54. (B) 'Bilateral' means involving two sides, so it is an agreement between two countries. An agreement among all nations would be multilateral or global. An internal arrangement involves no neighbour, so it is not bilateral. A country cannot make an agreement with the sea.

55. (C) A shared river is best managed by agreements among the sharing countries, balancing each side's needs. One country deciding alone breeds conflict over a shared resource. Leaving it unmanaged risks disputes and waste. A distant continent has no stake or standing to decide a local river.

56. (A) Both claims are wrong: Sri Lanka shares no land border and lies across the sea to the south, not the north, and Nepal is a landlocked Himalayan land neighbour, not a maritime one reached by sea. So neither claim holds, and the options crediting one or both are false.

57. (C) Sri Lanka really is a neighbour (A true), but the reason is wrong because a maritime link also makes a neighbour, so no land border is required (R false). R does not correctly explain A since R is false. A is not false; Sri Lanka is a neighbour. Both being false is wrong because A is true.

58. (C) Nepal depends on the sea for overseas trade (A true), and the reason explains why: its goods reach the ocean via Indian ports (R true and explanatory). So R does explain A. R is true, not false. A is true, not false, since landlocked Nepal still needs sea access.

59. (C) Indian culture is indeed present in Thailand and Cambodia (A true), but the reason is wrong because it spread by peaceful exchange, not conquest (R false). R cannot explain A since R is false. A is not false; the influence is real. Both being false is wrong since A is true.

60. (A) All three are wrong: a country's small size does not stop it being a maritime neighbour; an open border keeps Nepal a separate sovereign nation rather than part of India; and Buddhism arose in India and spread outward to lands like Indonesia, not the reverse. Since every statement fails, none is correct, so 'one', 'two' and 'all three' are all wrong.